that it was eight days' journey from both Goa and from Bombay, at the apex of a triangle formed by these two lines and the coast. For most cartographers of that time, this would have been more than enough information but D'Anville left Satara out of his map on the grounds that this was not exact enough.[19]

The British, meanwhile, were only marginally behind. The first half of the eighteenth century saw a series of British mapmakers—Herman Moll, John Thornton and Thomas Jefferys. Their records show that they keenly kept abreast of the latest French maps. There are also detailed local maps of specific ports and military installations. One of the most interesting is an English map of Maratha admiral Kanoji Angre's sea fort. From its fortified base at Vijaydurg, the Maratha navy harassed European shipping up and down the Konkan coast for several decades. Angre also defeated the Abyssinian pirates, the Sidis, but was unable to evict them from their base at Murud-Janjira.

The forts of Vijaydurg and Janjira lie south of Mumbai and are worth a visit. The fort at Janjira is built on a small island but local fishermen are happy to take visitors out on a rowboat for a small consideration. Vijaydurg is built on a peninsula but also offers spectacular views of the Arabian Sea. The eighteenth-century English map of Angre's fort shows a worryingly detailed knowledge of its defences. It also gives an amusing insight into the European attitude towards the Maratha admiral. Prominently marked is a building labelled as 'Godowns where he keeps his Plunder'. To them, he was no more than a pirate!

One of the characteristic features of European cartography till the mid-1700s is the obvious nautical orientation. By now, we have maps of India that show detailed depth measurements along the coast and even greater detail for the entrances of major ports. Yet, they remain curiously ignorant of the Himalayas, one of the most prominent geographical features on the planet. Most maps do show some awareness of mountains to the north, but the range is not systematically marked anywhere. There was a widespread belief going back to the time of Alexander that the northern mountains were a continuation of the Caucasus.